render(action: action_name)

Renders the template for a given action in this controller. Sometimes folks use the `:action` form of `render` when they should use redirects. See the discussion starting in *Redirects*, for why this is a bad idea.

```
def display_cart
  if @cart.empty?
    render(action: :index)
  else
    # ...
  end
end
```

Note that calling `render(:action...)` doesn't call the action method; it simply displays the template. If the template needs instance variables, these must be set up by the method that calls the `render` method.

Let's repeat this, because this is a mistake that beginners often make: calling `render(:action...)` doesn't invoke the action method. It simply renders that action's default template.

render(template: name, [locals: hash])

Renders a template and arranges for the resulting text to be sent back to the client. The `:template` value must contain both the controller and action parts of the new name, separated by a forward slash. The following code will render the template `app/views/blog/short_list`:

```
class BlogController < ApplicationController
  def index
    render(template: "blog/short_list")
  end
end
```

render(file: path)

Renders a view that may be entirely outside of your application (perhaps one shared with another Rails application). By default, the